



**Duo on the rise:** Ashwini Ponnappa (R) and Tanisha Crasto have developed a formidable partnership, as seen at the Yonex-Sunrise Guwahati Masters last year. RITU RAJ KONWAR

So much has been said about her and her remarkable victories. For me, her temperament stands out, which also includes her presence of mind. It's not only about being calm, but it's also about making the right decisions and having the right clarity under that kind of pressure. I liken this to the Neeraj Chopra brand of simplicity and calm. Her attitude was a mix of ambition and humility - it's like she's saying, 'I'm here, I'm self-assured. I know I don't know it all but I am confident of what I do know and with that I will do my utmost best for the team'. Such brilliance in one match is fine, but to do it thrice against

higher-ranked opponents in the deciding match of the tie at such a young age is remarkable.

#### **When the giants return**

The big names will return. Every match, against any opponent, is a learning opportunity. Each match is like a ladder you climb to get closer to the top. Now whether you play them in a World Tour event, a Team Championship or anywhere else, the brief is the same. You must scale those rounds and gain that experience, to get ahead.

Sindhu is the top ranked Indian player in